UPSC Current Affairs

Sunday, 15 November 2026 · Sources: PIB and The Hindu · 18 items

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GS2	13	Amidst Indus water tensions, Pakistan to send vocal critic t; Andhra Pradesh attracted ■9.89 lakh crore in investments aft
GS3	1	‘Abki baar, AQI 400-paar’: Congress takes a swipe at Modi ov

Every item links to its original source: tap a headline or the Source line to open the full article on thehindu.com or the press release on pib.gov.in. The Hindu text here is only the short RSS excerpt.

GS Paper I: Heritage, Culture, History, Geography & Society

GEOGRAPHY

Quad Summit likely to be held in Manila on November 17, sources say

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, International Relations

• The Summit between leaders of India, U.S., Australia, and Japan is being held in a non-Quad country for the first time, expected to address critical minerals and energy supply chains and safety of seafarers

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.
• **International relations:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BRICS).

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Quad Summit, Manila, November, Summit, Australia

Static connect: Quad

• India, the United States, Japan and Australia; focus on a free and open Indo-Pacific.
UPSC angle: Indo-Pacific strategy (GS2).
Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/quad-summit-likely-to-be-held-in-manila-on-nov

HISTORY & ART AND CULTURE

Chaya Literature Festival brings together writers and artistes from across languages

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · History & Art and Culture, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• Chaya Literature Festival brings together writers and artistes from across languages

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Chaya Literature Festival
Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/telangana/chaya-literature-festival-brings-together

From a rustic tradition to world recognition, Meghalaya’s Wangala festival marks a flourishing heritage

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · History & Art and Culture, Agriculture

• Wangala, a harvest festival of the Garo community, went from a small tradition with less than 10 drummers to an organised event with 100 drums in 1976; fifty years later, the farmers’ event saw 1,500 dancers and 1,000 drummers celebrating the end of the period of toil in a record-breaking performance

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** Agriculture employs about 45% of workers; MSP, procurement and input prices affect farm incomes, food inflation and the subsidy bill.
• **Governance & polity:** Debates on MSP legal guarantee, crop diversification away from water-intensive paddy, and agricultural marketing reforms.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: From, Meghalaya, Wangala, Garo

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/meghalaya/from-a-rustic-tradition-to-world-recognit

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

Keralam Speaker’s absence from endosulfan victims’ memorial event triggers row

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, History & Art and Culture

• Thiruvanchoor blames ‘communication lapse’ for not attending the unveiling of the 40-foot-tall sculpture created by sculptor Kanayi Kunhiraman; Kasaragod district panchayat maintains that he was informed through proper channels

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Keralam Speaker, Thiruvanchoor, Kanayi Kunhiraman, Kasaragod

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/keralam-speakers-absence-from-endosulfan-vic

GS Paper II: Polity, Governance, Social Justice & IR

ECONOMY

Andhra Pradesh attracted ■9.89 lakh crore in investments after CII summit, says MP

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• P4 model seeks to channel corporate CSR funds into education, village development and employment, says Kalisetti Appalanaidu

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Andhra Pradesh, CII, CSR, Kalisetti Appalanaidu

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/andhra-pradesh-attracts-989-lakh-cro

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

SCoR, Central Bank of India ink pact to extend welfare facilities for railway staff

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, International Relations, Economy

• SCoR, Central Bank of India ink pact to extend welfare facilities for railway staff

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: SCoR, Central Bank of India

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/scor-central-bank-of-india-ink-pact-

Why LED lights feel blinding, and what they mean for eye health

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, International Relations, Economy

• Constant exposure can cause mild to extreme visual discomfort, glare, eye strain, headaches and sleep disturbances for some people, doctors say, emphasising the importance of reducing exposure where possible, and taking breaks during prolonged screen time

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Why LED, Constant

Source: The Hindu, Health, 13 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/why-led-lights-feel-blinding-and-what-they-mean-f

Myanmar airstrike on displaced persons camp kills 12, say witnesses

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Mains · Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• An airstrike by Myanmar's military on a camp for internally displaced persons killed 12 people.
• Myanmar remains gripped by civil war following the military coup five years ago, facing resistance from democratic and ethnic armed groups.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

Escalating civil conflict in Myanmar directly drives refugee flows, cross-border ethnic friction, and security vulnerabilities into India's border states.
• **Internal security:** Civilian displacement and clashes near the border heighten infiltration risks and supply routes for northeastern insurgent outfits.
• **International relations:** Complicates India's diplomatic balancing between engagement with the ruling junta and regional humanitarian responsibilities.

Prelims pointers

• Myanmar shares land borders with four Indian states: Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, and Mizoram.

Static connect: India–Myanmar Border Dynamics

• India shares an approximately 1,643 km long international border with Myanmar.
• The Free Movement Regime (FMR), which permitted border residents to travel 16 km into each other's territory without visas, was decided to be scrapped by India due to security concerns.
UPSC angle: Frequently tested under border management, insurgency, and Act East Policy.

Mains angle

Assesses the security and humanitarian spillovers of Myanmar's instability on India's North-Eastern border (GS Paper II and III).

Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/myanmar-airstrike-on-displaced-persons-camp-ki

Indian Railways to connect Nepal’s Janakpur Dham with Ayodhya through weekly train service

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Prelims · Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• Indian Railways is introducing a weekly train service connecting Nepal’s Janakpur Dham with Ayodhya in Uttar Pradesh.
• The designated route will pass through multiple regional stations including Jaynagar, Sitamarhi, Raxaul, and Gorakhpur.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

Strengthening transit links reinforces India's 'Neighbourhood First' policy while deepening people-to-people and economic ties with landlocked Nepal.
• **International relations:** Bolsters the Ramayana Circuit connectivity and acts as soft-power leverage amid growing external influence in Nepal.
• **Economy:** Promotes regional tourism, local trade, and services sector growth across Bihar and Uttar Pradesh border corridors.

Prelims pointers

• Janakpur Dham is a major cultural and religious site located in the Mithila region of Nepal.
• Jaynagar (Bihar) serves as a key cross-border railway junction connecting India to Nepal's railway network.

Static connect: India-Nepal Connectivity

• Cross-border broad-gauge passenger rail services between India (Jaynagar) and Nepal (Kurtha/Bijalpura) were revived under Indian grant assistance.
• India and Nepal share an open border under the 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship.
UPSC angle: Pertains to neighborhood connectivity, cultural diplomacy, and bilateral infrastructure projects.

Mains angle

Analyzes the role of cross-border infrastructure and religious-cultural diplomacy in India-Nepal bilateral relations (GS Paper II).

Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/indian-railways-to-connect-nepals-janakpur-dham-wit

Fear of diagnosis keeping people away from diabetes screening, finds IDF survey

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Mains · Governance & Social Justice, Reports & Indices

• An International Diabetes Federation (IDF) survey showed that fear of diagnosis deters individuals from routine diabetes screening.
• While 84% of surveyed adults in India acknowledged the value of screening, only 14% considered themselves at risk of developing Type 2 Diabetes.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

India hosts one of the world's largest diabetic populations, making early detection and health literacy critical for preventing long-term public health strain.
• **Society:** Psychological aversion and low personal risk perception impede health-seeking behavior, compounding the non-communicable disease burden.
• **Economy:** Undiagnosed diabetes leads to chronic complications, raising out-of-pocket health expenditures and decreasing workforce productivity.

Prelims pointers

• Type 2 diabetes is a non-communicable lifestyle disease characterized by insulin resistance and relative lack of insulin.
• The International Diabetes Federation publishes the global Diabetes Atlas.

Static connect: Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) in India

• The National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases (NP-NCD) targets early screening for diabetes, hypertension, and common cancers.
• India signed up for WHO's global target to halt the rise in diabetes and obesity by 2025.
UPSC angle: Relevant for issues related to health infrastructure, disease burdens, and preventative healthcare.

Mains angle

Discusses non-communicable disease burden and public health behavioral barriers in India under social sector initiatives (GS Paper II).

Source: The Hindu, Health, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/fear-of-diagnosis-keeping-people-away-fro

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Amidst Indus water tensions, Pakistan to send vocal critic to SCO Civilisational Dialogue; first Ministerial visit in three years

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• Malik, the Federal Minister for Climate Change and Environmental Coordination, had earlier this year said that Pakistan would ‘cut off those hands’ that are trying to control the Indus waters

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Cross-border terrorism and infiltration across the LoC remain India's core security concern; links to J&K, drones dropping arms/drugs in Punjab, and terror financing (FATF).
• **International relations:** India's stated policy: no talks with terror; Indus Waters Treaty (1960) held in abeyance since April 2025; China–Pakistan nexus including CPEC through PoK.
• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Amidst Indus, Pakistan, SCO Civilisational Dialogue, Ministerial, Malik

Static connect: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)

• Founded in 2001; India and Pakistan became full members in 2017.
• Secretariat in Beijing; Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) in Tashkent.
UPSC angle: India's engagement with Central Asia, China and Russia (GS2).

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/pakistan-climate-minister-sco-summit-india-vis

A.P. attracts major investments at CII summit in Visakhapatnam

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations, Economy, Science & Technology

• HSL-Cyient DLM pact to boost indigenous marine electronics; MEIL and fabrIQ commit ■43,700 crore to projects expected to generate over 1.06 lakh jobs

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** Jobs for a young workforce decide whether India reaps its demographic dividend; PLFS tracks the labour force participation rate.
• **Society:** Rising gig and platform work needs social security (Code on Social Security 2020); low female labour force participation remains a gap.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: CII, Visakhapatnam, HSL-Cyient DLM, MEIL

Source: The Hindu, National, 14 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/ap-attracts-major-investments-at-cii

U.S. proposes Ukraine cede territory in exchange for joining NATO: Zelensky

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• Volodymyr Zelensky said Russia had rejected a ceasefire on energy targets at talks in Abu Dhabi, as Moscow was “betting everything” on this winter’s campaign

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.
• **International relations:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BRICS).
• **Internal security:** Dependence on Russian defence equipment (S-400, Su-30) and the push for indigenisation (Atmanirbhar Bharat in defence).

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Ukraine, NATO, Zelensky, Volodymyr Zelensky, Russia

Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/us-proposes-ukraine-cede-territory-in-exchange

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

To strengthen the Supreme Court, divide it

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• Highlights structural problems in the Supreme Court where expanding judge strength without categorizing work exacerbates judicial pendency.
• Argues for dividing the Supreme Court into distinct constitutional and appellate divisions to address structural backlog effectively.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

Judicial delay affects governance, rule of law, and economic productivity. Structural division of the top court is a recurrent theme in constitutional reform debates.
• **Governance & polity:** Separating constitutional interpretation from ordinary statutory appeals preserves the apex court's core role and decongests the docket.
• **Economy:** A predictable and swift dispute resolution mechanism lowers the cost of doing business and enhances investor confidence.

Prelims pointers

• Article 130 allows the Chief Justice of India to appoint other places or seats for the Supreme Court with the President's approval.
• The Law Commission of India (229th Report) recommended dividing the Supreme Court into a Constitution Bench and Cassation Benches.

Static connect: Structure of the Supreme Court of India

• Established under Article 124 of the Constitution of India.
• Functions both as the apex constitutional court and a final court of appeal under civil, criminal, and special leave jurisdictions (Article 136).
• Parliament possesses the legislative power to regulate the number of Supreme Court judges.
UPSC angle: Relevant for questions on judicial reforms, separation of powers, and institutional pendency under GS Paper II.

Mains angle

Examines judicial reforms, specifically restructuring the Supreme Court into constitutional and appellate divisions to improve judicial efficiency (GS Paper II).

Practice question

Bifurcating the Supreme Court into a Constitutional Division and a National Court of Appeal has long been suggested to tackle chronic pendency. Analyze the merits and constitutional challenges associated with this reform.

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/to-strengthen-the-supreme-court-divide-it/article716

What are the legal compulsions and political hurdles in Sheikh Hasina’s return to Bangladesh? | Explained

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, International Relations

• Ousted Bangladeshi leader Sheikh Hasina seeks to return to domestic politics, but faces a death sentence issued by Dhaka's International Crimes Tribunal over crackdowns in July-August 2024.
• Her presence in India creates complex diplomatic pressures and legal extradition issues between New Delhi and Dhaka.

Why it matters for India and UPSC

Bangladesh is central to India's Act East strategy, internal security in the Northeast, and Bay of Bengal maritime cooperation; regime hostility complicates all three.
• **International relations:** Creates a diplomatic impasse between honouring formal extradition pacts and safeguarding long-term strategic relationships.
• **Internal security:** Political turmoil in Bangladesh poses risks of border instability, undocumented migration, and potential regrouping of anti-India elements.
• **Governance & polity:** Invokes interpretation of the Extradition Act, 1962 and treaty clauses governing political crimes and human rights guarantees.

Prelims pointers

• India and Bangladesh signed an Extradition Treaty in 2013, amended in 2016 to simplify cross-border extraditions.

Static connect: India's Extradition Framework

• Extraditions from India are governed by the Extradition Act, 1962.
• Most bilateral extradition treaties, including India's, include a 'political offence' clause exempting political asylum seekers, with exceptions for violent or terrorist acts.
UPSC angle: Directly links to GS Paper II topics on India and its neighborhood and bilateral legal mechanisms.

Mains angle

Evaluates the legal, diplomatic, and security repercussions of extradition demands and regime change in Bangladesh on bilateral ties (GS Paper II).

Practice question

The ongoing political transition in Bangladesh poses multifaceted diplomatic and strategic challenges for India. Discuss the legal hurdles and diplomatic dilemmas India faces regarding extradition demands and neighborhood stability.

Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/sheikh-hasinas-return-to-bangladesh-the-hurdle

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REPORTS & INDICES

Trump tells advisers he may hold off on Iran attacks barring new provocations, sources say

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Reports & Indices, International Relations

• The war has hiked global fuel prices and proven unpopular with U.S.
• voters, who handed control ■of ■Congress to the Democrats in last week's midterm elections

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Economy:** US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.
• **International relations:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BRICS).
• **Society:** About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are at stake.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Trump, Iran, Congress, Democrats

Source: The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/trump-tells-advisers-he-may-hold-off-on-iran-a

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ALSO IN THE NEWS (LOWER PRIORITY)

• Riots in France: How anti-Government protests spiralled out of control (The Hindu, International, 14 Nov 2026)

GS Paper III: Economy, Environment, S&T, Security & DM

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

‘Abki baar, AQI 400-paar’: Congress takes a swipe at Modi over Delhi pollution

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• Referring to reports of worsening air quality in Delhi, Jairam Ramesh said the city had become the most polluted in the world, with toxic air making breathing difficult

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Environment:** Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.
• **Governance & polity:** Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.
• **Economy:** RBI's MPC targets 4% CPI inflation (±2%); rate decisions affect EMIs, credit growth, investment and the rupee.
• **Society:** Food inflation hits poor households the most; links to supply-side measures like buffer stocks and export curbs.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Abki, AQI, Congress, Modi, Delhi

Static connect: Air quality governance

• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.
UPSC angle: Pollution control framework (GS3).

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 14 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/abki-baar-aqi-400-paar-says-congress-takes-a-sw